Executive Summary Template · Expert version

An executive summary template helps you condense a business plan, proposal or report into one page that a busy decision-maker can read in two minutes and act on.

How to use this template

1. Finish the full document first.
2. Write one to three sentences per element.
3. Lead with the decision or recommendation.
4. Use numbers instead of adjectives.
5. Cut anything the reader does not need to decide.

Tips

- Aim for one page or less.
- Avoid jargon and acronyms.
- Make the ask impossible to miss.
- Test it on someone who has not read the full document.

Executive summary · Fit it on one page; write it last

Element	Guidance	Your text (1-3 sentences)
Purpose	Why this document exists and what decision is needed.	
Problem or opportunity	The issue and why it matters now.	
Solution / recommendation	What you propose.	
Key benefits	Top two or three benefits, quantified.	
Key numbers	Cost, return, timeline, market size.	
Risks	The main risk and mitigation.	
Status / progress	For reports: where things stand.	
The ask / next steps	Exactly what you need, from whom, by when.	